By TOUCH DEN · November 11, 2026

Security Roles and the Industry



Video 1 · The Families of Security Work

Security Fundamentals · Section 11

In this video, you will learn:

- The four broad families of security roles
- Offensive and defensive roles
- Engineering and GRC roles

The shape of the industry

Security isn't one job, it's a whole industry of specialties, like "medicine".

- ***Offensive (red):*** *find weaknesses by attacking, with permission.*
- ***Defensive (blue):*** *watch for, detect, and respond to attacks.*
- ***Engineering / architecture:*** *build systems secure by design.*
- ***GRC:*** *manage security as a business, policy, risk, audits.*

You don't have to be a brilliant hacker. *Many top roles are defensive, engineering, or GRC. Demand far exceeds supply, including locally and remotely.*

Offensive and defensive roles

Offensive (ethical hackers), with permission:

- ***Pentester:*** *test a scoped system, report the fixes.*
- ***Red teamer:*** *broad, stealthy, goal-based engagements.*
- ***Bug bounty hunter:*** *independent, via published programs.*

Defensive (blue, the larger side, where many start):

- ***SOC analyst:*** *watch alerts and logs, a common entry job.*
- ***Incident responder:*** *contain and recover from incidents.*
- ***Forensics / threat intel / threat hunter.***

Both are more methodical testing and ***report writing*** *than dramatic hacking.*

Engineering and GRC roles

Engineering / architecture, build security in:

- ***Security engineer:*** *build and run defenses, automate.*
- ***AppSec / cloud engineer:*** *secure software and cloud.*
- ***Security architect:*** *design how it all fits together.*

GRC, security as a business function (not technical):

- ***GRC analyst, auditor, compliance manager, CISO.***
- *Rewards organization, communication, and process.*

Both families are among the most in-demand and best-paid.

Recap: the families

- Four families: **offensive, defensive, engineering, GRC**, matching the program's paths.
- You don't need to be an elite hacker; most roles value care and communication.
- Defensive (SOC) is a common entry point; engineering and GRC are in high demand.

Next video: how the roles work together, and certifications.

Security Roles and the Industry



Video 2 · Working Together, and Certifications

Security Fundamentals · Section 11

In this video, you will learn:

- How the roles form one system (purple team)
- The main certifications at a glance
- The honest truth about certs vs. skills

How the roles work together

Not rival camps, one system of defense.

- ***Red + blue = purple.*** *A* ***purple team*** *is a way of working: red shows blue exactly how an attack works, so blue can detect and block it. Both sides improve the defenses together.*
- ***Engineers build*** *what blue monitors and red tests. A pentest finding becomes an engineer's fix and a SOC detection.*
- ***GRC sets the priorities*** *by risk, and reports to leadership.*

Understanding every role makes you better at your own.

Certifications at a glance

A common (imperfect) way to signal knowledge. You need none to start.

Level	Examples	For
Entry	CompTIA Security+	Broad fundamentals; many first jobs
Offensive	OSCP, CEH	Pentest / red team
Defensive	SOC / blue-team certs	Operations, IR, forensics
Management/GRC	CISSP, CISM	Senior, architecture, governance
Cloud	Cloud-provider certs	Cloud security

Certs vs. skills: the honest truth

- ***Certifications help you get interviews.***
- ***Skills and a portfolio get you hired**, and keep you employed.*

Hands-on practice, labs, CTFs, real projects, matters more than collecting letters.

*Don't feel you must chase certs to belong: many excellent practitioners have few, and build their reputation on **demonstrated work**.*

That demonstrated work is what the rest of this program builds.

Recap: together, and certs

- *The roles form one system;* ***purple teaming*** *(red + blue collaborating) produces the best defenses.*
- *Certifications open interviews;* ***skills and a portfolio get the job.***
- *Know every role to be better at your own.*

Next lesson: *your learning roadmap, turning all of this into a plan.*